Blackwish From 2D Scene to Finished Film

A practical research guide

Prepared 22 October 2026. Research and proposed applications, not a production authorization.

A 2D film is not simply a stack of drawings. It coordinates a chosen combination of story, visual design, performance, time, sound and technical delivery; silent or abstract films need not use every element. The practical task is to make each stage pass useful information to the next without confusing a plan with a finished result.

The central distinction is this: a script describes intended events; a storyboard proposes their visual presentation; an animatic tests a timed audiovisual arrangement; layout establishes how selected shots will be constructed; animation creates performance over time; finishing integrates and delivers the result. An approved board does not prove that the animated performance works, and an exported movie does not prove that the editable project can be reopened.

This guide covers the major processes involved in making 2D scenes, shorts and longer films. It includes hand-drawn, cutout, deformable and mixed workflows, rather than treating one technique or studio organization as universal. Individual productions combine, rename, repeat or omit stages according to their medium and needs. It is not an exhaustive catalog of every animation technique.

For Blackwish, the useful immediate application is text-first: clearer scene specifications, alternatives, continuity questions, timing hypotheses and handoff descriptions. These are proposed applications, not claims that Blackwish already implements a film-production system. This research does not authorize a visual-engine branch, installations, purchases, external casting, human experiments or deployment.

How to use this guide. Read the stage map first, then the methods and worked example. Use the delivery checklist only after defining the intended platform and audience. The proposed review controls at the end are open to manual ratification; source-supported technical facts and artistic interpretations do not become true through ratification.

Primary evidence consists of official application documentation and professional role descriptions. The tools and examples are selected research starting points, not a tested integration stack. Where an evidence item was available only as an indexed official excerpt, that limitation is identified. Acceptance questions and worked examples are this report's synthesis, not a claim that every studio uses the same gates.

The production map

Development. Define the audience, purpose, story or explanatory objective, tone, scope and constraints. Establish an achievable runtime and the kind of movement the project needs. A solo filmmaker still performs multiple roles, even when there are no departmental handoffs.

Preproduction. Develop the script or outline, characters, environments, visual references, boards and animatic. Plan voice recording, music, accessibility and asset rights early enough to affect the cut. Choose a timebase and delivery assumptions, while clearly marking what remains provisional.

Production. Build shot layouts and backgrounds; prepare drawings or rigs; animate characters, props and effects; review motion and performance; clean and color where required. Track retakes against the selected edit and asset versions.

Postproduction. Composite layers, refine editorial, edit and mix sound, prepare captions and other required access versions, render masters and distribution copies, and inspect the actual outputs.

Preservation. Archive both the finished film and the editable production materials with dependencies, rights records and instructions for reopening. A playable delivery copy is not a complete production archive.

These are overlapping responsibilities, not a one-way conveyor. A sound edit may reveal a pacing problem; layout may expose an impossible camera move; an acting test may justify changing the animatic. The aim is controlled revision, not a prohibition on revision.

Roles and planning. Typical responsibilities include writing, directing, producing, storyboarding, design, editorial, layout, backgrounds, animation, cleanup, color, compositing and sound. One person may cover several. Assign a decision owner and a receiver for consequential handoffs. Plan by shot complexity and dependency, not runtime alone: a brief crowd transformation may require more work than a long held conversation. No universal staffing ratio, budget or schedule is assumed here.

Sources: Toon Boom Producer workflow; ScreenSkills animation writer.

Vocabulary that prevents production mistakes

Sequence and scene. A narrative scene is an event in a place and time; a sequence can group several related events. Software may use scene to mean a single production shot. State which convention applies rather than assuming the word has one meaning.

Shot and panel. A shot is a continuous camera presentation between edits. A storyboard panel is one selected visual moment; several panels can describe one shot. One panel can also be held for a long interval in an animatic.

Frame and drawing. An output frame is one temporal sample of the delivered movie. A drawing is an image that may occupy one frame, many frames or multiple repeated intervals. A frame rate does not specify how many new drawings an artist must make.

Exposure and hold. Exposure tells when and for how long a drawing appears. On twos, each exposure lasts two output frames: at 24 fps, twelve drawing exposures per second, not necessarily twelve unique drawings. Layers may update at different rates.

Key drawing and property keyframe. A key drawing describes an important pose. A software property keyframe records a value at a time, such as rotation or opacity. Neither necessarily

supplies the artistic decisions between two poses. A breakdown describes the route or character of an action between major poses; inbetweens complete the chosen spacing.

Layout and background. Layout specifies the spatial construction of the shot. A background is artwork used within that construction. A pleasing standalone illustration may lack the extra area or separated layers a moving camera requires.

Master and project. A master is a high-quality finished output prepared for a defined purpose. A project is an editable arrangement of source assets and instructions. Keep both; do not call either a substitute for the other.

Illustrative arithmetic. A two-second panel at an expressly chosen 24 fps occupies 48 output frames. It could contain one held drawing, a camera movement over artwork, changing mouth shapes, or a fully redrawn performance. These alternatives have the same duration but different production work and visual results.

Sources: Storyboard Pro glossary; OpenToonz Xsheet.

Develop a story that can be staged

Start with a short brief: who is the audience, what should they understand or feel, and what changes during the scene? Narrative projects may use conflict and character goals; educational films may use a question, demonstration and explanation. Neither requires fantasy or photorealism.

A script or outline should distinguish visible action, spoken words, offscreen sound and information the audience does not yet have. Internal feelings can guide performance, but they are not automatically visible. For example, "the witness distrusts the interviewer" leaves a staging decision open: withdrawal, a delayed reply, a glance toward the door, contradictory politeness or something deliberately less readable.

Do not fill every ambiguity automatically. A mystery may need controlled uncertainty; comedy may need a pause; a documentary diagram may need explicit labels instead of facial performance. Specify the intended uncertainty and preserve alternatives until the appropriate review.

Design translates the chosen story into repeatable visual choices. Character sheets can establish silhouette, proportions, costume, expressions and construction. Prop sheets resolve how objects open, turn or connect. Environment design establishes location and visual relationships. A design bible provides operational reference; a mood board provides inspiration and is not sufficient construction guidance by itself.

Color planning has several scales. A character palette records repeatable asset colors. A color script plans the progression of visual mood across shots or sequences. Technical color management determines how values are interpreted through applications and displays. Confusing these produces both artistic and technical errors.

Suggested handoff. Provide the brief, selected script version, relevant design sheets, unresolved alternatives and a list of assets whose origin or usage rights remain unsettled. Keep exploratory concepts separate from approved production references.

Review questions. Can important beats be staged in images, sound or a deliberate withholding of information? Can another artist construct the same character? Does a lighting change preserve identity where intended? Are the scope and style compatible with the actual team and available time?

Sources: ScreenSkills character designer; Pixar in a Box color and visual language; ScreenSkills writer.

Storyboards and animatics

Storyboarding selects viewpoint, shot size, framing, staging, screen direction, entrances, eyelines and transitions. It turns a written intention into a visual proposition. Panels should communicate what the audience can actually see, not merely what the artist knows happened outside the frame.

An animatic places those boards in time. It combines selected panels with durations, cuts and provisional or final sound. It may include simple camera or layer movement, but it need not animate every panel. Its purpose is to expose pacing and audiovisual relationships before expensive finish work.

Watch an animatic continuously at its intended playback speed. Inspecting still panels cannot establish whether a reveal registers, a subtitle can be read or a pause feels deliberate. Conversely, a successful rough cut does not establish the quality of the eventual acting, linework or mix.

Scratch dialogue can help test duration. Final voice recording often needs to precede detailed lip-sync and performance decisions, although workflows vary. Casting and recording plans should cover the character or narration requirement, performance direction, takes, naming, recording conditions and permitted uses. A temporary voice or music track must remain visibly temporary in the production records. Replacing it can change timing.

Editorial decisions should be versioned. Record the selected cut, shot durations, audio status and unresolved notes. "Lock" means a controlled baseline with a change process, not a claim that the project can never change. In Storyboard Pro, even locking scene duration does not prevent every operation from altering length.

Suggested handoff. Supply the reference movie with a visible version identifier, the editable board project, a shot list, current audio and a note of intentional placeholders. State the timebase. When a duration changes, identify which downstream shots, captions, audio or effects need reconsideration.

Failure example. The board clearly shows a missing envelope, but the animatic cuts away before a viewer can notice the empty drawer. Adding more drawing detail does not solve the missing viewing time.

Sources: ScreenSkills storyboard artist; Storyboard Pro animatics; Storyboard Pro timing; Lock scene duration (official indexed evidence).

Layout backgrounds and reusable assets

Layout turns selected boards into a shot that can be built. It resolves perspective, scale, camera framing, character positions, relevant poses and the extent of artwork beyond the visible frame. It also resolves which elements must be separated to move or occlude one another.

For a horizontal camera move, the background needs sufficient painted area outside the opening frame. A foreground doorway may need its own layer so a character can pass behind it. A cutout hand holding a cup may require an alternate drawing when the grip changes. These are dependencies, not merely aesthetic refinements.

Background work develops scenery, lighting, texture and foreground relationships. It should support the action rather than compete with it. Reuse is useful when the shot genuinely shares a construction; it can fail when perspective, time of day or camera placement differs.

Track an asset separately from its instances. One source chair can appear in several shots with different transforms or occlusion. Replacing its source may affect every dependent shot, while moving one instance should not silently change the others. A thumbnail or tracking association is not proof that the receiving scene contains the correct editable asset.

Camera motion, object motion and perceived screen motion are separate. Moving the camera across a still room is not the same event as sliding a character through that room. Scaling artwork can suggest distance, but it does not reveal unseen surfaces. Layered 2.5D arrangements can create parallax; an orbit may require new views or other geometry.

Suggested layout package. Shot identifier, selected board and cut version, timing, dimensions and camera requirements, layer order, background extent, character placements, asset versions, foreground masks and unresolved construction notes. The receiver should be able to reproduce the intended framing before animating.

Export warning. An exported representation may omit behavior. Toon Boom's PSD layout guidance notes that only the first frame of drawing layers is exported; a layered still must not be mistaken for the full motion scene.

Sources: ScreenSkills layout artist; ScreenSkills background designer; Harmony PSD export (official indexed evidence); OpenToonz movement and hierarchy.

Choose an animation method for the scene

Hand drawn frame by frame. The artist draws selected poses and transitions. Raster workflows work with pixels; vector workflows represent shapes or strokes that can be edited differently. Frame-by-frame work can accommodate substantial changes of shape and viewpoint, but cleanup, consistent construction and revision remain labor.

Cutout or puppet animation. Characters and props are divided into parts with pivots, parenting and keyframed transforms. Inverse kinematics can help control connected parts. Reuse can accelerate recurring performance, but a rig only contains the shapes and behaviors that have been authored. Extreme turns, overlapping limbs or a new hand action may require alternate artwork rather than another transform.

Mesh deformation. A mesh or skeleton bends existing art instead of moving only rigid pieces. This can be useful for flexible shapes, but deformation quality depends on construction and controls. More detail is not free: mesh density can affect both results and resource use. Inspect unwanted stretching, texture distortion and volume changes.

Hybrid scenes. A production can combine puppet body motion with drawn facial changes, frame-by-frame effects, camera movement and static backgrounds. Mixed methods should share an intentional visual language. A mismatch can be expressive; it should not be dismissed or accepted without considering the intended result.

Limited animation. Holds, repeated cycles, selective movement and restrained changes can be deliberate style and production choices. A face may change while the body holds. A graphic explanation may need only a moving indicator. Judge whether the intended information and performance are conveyed, not whether every pixel moves.

Selection questions. Does the scene need new viewpoints or extreme deformation? Is the design reusable? How often will dialogue or poses change? What kind of revision is likely? Can the team maintain the chosen construction? Test the hardest representative action before committing a whole film to an unproven method.

This is a proposed selection framework, not a measured ranking of tools or a claim that any method is always cheaper or better.

Sources: Krita animation workflow; OpenToonz cutout animation; OpenToonz Plastic tool.

Other routes into a 2D scene

Paper to digital. A hand-drawn workflow can begin on paper, then scan and register the drawings before digital cleanup, color and compositing. Numbering and registration matter because the drawing must be associated with the intended exposure and position. Scanning is not the same operation as cleanup, and neither guarantees an animation-ready result.

Optional vectorization. Raster artwork can be converted to vectors, but conversion changes the representation. OpenToonz distinguishes centerline conversion, which creates variable-width strokes, from outline conversion, which traces boundaries. Inspect whether the result preserves the desired line quality and shapes rather than treating conversion as lossless.

Rotoscoping and reference. Rotoscoping traces or adapts movement from live-action frames. Observational reference can instead inform newly staged drawings without direct tracing. Photoshop documents drawing on a separate video layer above source footage. These are artistic methods, not automatic proof of originality or permission to use the source material. Record provenance and resolve permitted use separately.

Reuse and cycles. A stored walk or run cycle can be re-exposed, adapted or combined with other actions. Inspect the loop seam, contact and relation between world travel and screen movement. A cycle that works in place may not work against a scrolling background without adjustment. Repetition is a defect only when it is unintended or conflicts with the desired action.

Historical contrast. Physical cel production places transparent artwork over backgrounds and photographs the arrangement. Digital layers can perform related compositional roles without reproducing that physical process. This distinction helps explain the origin of some terminology; it does not make historical cel methods a required stage of digital filmmaking.

Sources: OpenToonz production workflow; OpenToonz raster to vector conversion; Adobe video layers and rotoscoping; Adobe cel animation method.

Make movement and performance intentional

Pose-to-pose work plans major poses and then develops the passages between them. Straight-ahead work develops motion forward. Hybrid approaches are possible. The choice should serve the action and the artist, not become a universal prescription.

Timing concerns when events happen and how long they last. Spacing concerns the progression of positions or shapes between those times. Identical endpoints and duration can yield a slow departure, a sudden stop, a mechanical glide or a hesitant reach, depending on the intervening choices.

Staging, anticipation, arcs, overlap, follow-through, squash and stretch are useful craft ideas, not mandatory tests of realism. A machine may move in a straight line; a diagram may need rigid geometry; an interruption may intentionally omit anticipation. The question is whether the movement serves the scene and style.

Review contact and weight where they matter. A foot can appear to slide if the body's travel and the planted foot do not agree. Automatic translation or interpolation does not establish grounded locomotion. Check the relation between the character, camera and ground before blaming the drawing rate.

Lip-sync aligns mouth changes with speech, but mouth alignment is not the whole performance. OpenToonz supports audio scrubbing and mouth substitutions. Its Rhubarb workflow exposes supplied mouth drawings; it does not invent acting or create every drawing. Gaze, posture, breathing, gesture and silence can contradict otherwise accurate mouth timing.

Effects animation also has event timing. Rain, a spill, dust or steam needs an onset, interaction and disappearance appropriate to the action. Compositing can change glow or opacity, but appearance alone does not determine when an effect should occur.

Suggested review order. First judge the action at speed; then examine poses, spacing and technical defects. Separate a storytelling note from a cleanup note. A held pose is not automatically a defect, and smoother interpolation is not automatically better acting.

Sources: Adobe key poses and animation approaches; Adobe principles of animation (official indexed excerpt); Krita animation workflow; OpenToonz Xsheet and lip-sync; OpenToonz special effects.

Clean color and manage revisions

Rough animation is a performance proposal, not necessarily final linework. Cleanup clarifies shapes and line decisions while preserving the intended motion. Color work fills or paints the selected drawings and maintains the chosen design. Some styles intentionally retain rough marks or painterly variation; cleanup should not erase the style by default.

Palette-driven workflows can separate a color style from the individual areas using it, making coordinated changes possible. That convenience creates a dependency: changing a shared palette may alter more than the currently visible drawing. Verify the affected range rather than assuming a change is local.

A practical retake note identifies the shot and version, the interval, the observed problem, the intended outcome and the kind of evidence needed to close it. "Make it better" is less actionable than "the hand releases the cup before the table contact; preserve the pause but resolve the contact." Avoid prescribing a single drawing solution when several may work.

Separate stages of acceptance. Motion may be accepted while line cleanup remains open; a shot may be visually accepted while final sound or permissions remain unresolved. "Done" without a named deliverable and scope is difficult to hand off safely.

Preserve earlier versions when changing a selected cut, rig or asset. Keep a short change record that distinguishes revised content from a different export of the same content. A receiver should know which version replaces which and which unresolved notes remain.

Suggested shot record. Identifier; owner; cut version; source asset versions; work stage; review status; outstanding notes; export reference; required dependencies. This is a lightweight proposal, not a demand for a large production database.

Source: OpenToonz painting animation levels. The revision and review conventions above are proposed practice, not a source-mandated universal workflow.

Compositing and editorial finishing

Compositing combines the selected backgrounds, character layers, props, foregrounds and effects into the shot. Masks, opacity, shadows, layer order and camera relationships determine what is visible. Review the moving result: a background edge or incorrect overlap may appear only partway through a shot.

Transparency also has technical representation. Straight and premultiplied alpha encode color differently; incompatible interpretation can produce edge problems. Blender's documented

Alpha Over behavior expects a premultiplied foreground. This is a specific documented behavior, not a universal setting to copy into every application.

Color management concerns how source, working and display values are interpreted. Artistic grading concerns the chosen appearance. Blender documents a scene-linear workflow with source and display assignments; this does not require every stylized film to look photorealistic or use HDR delivery. Record the color assumptions at a handoff and inspect the receiving application.

Editorial evolves as boards are replaced by rough animation and finished composites. Conforming means inserting the correct new material while retaining the intended cut. Record source and timeline in/out points, version and timebase. Handles are extra frames outside the used cut that may support transitions or revisions.

Retiming is not one operation. Changing playback rate, repeating or dropping drawings, changing exposures and interpolating new samples can produce different results. Audio may need separate treatment. Recheck rhythm, contact and lip-sync after any consequential retime; do not assume a new duration preserves the performance.

Suggested checks. Wrong render version, missing first or last frames, unexpected holds, alpha fringes, clipped artwork, wrong occlusion, exposed background edges, unintended blur or glow, color discontinuity and sound drift. A timeline interchange file can describe editorial structure while still referencing external media; it is not inherently a self-contained backup.

Sources: Blender Alpha Over and Blender color spaces (official indexed evidence); OpenTimelineIO overview; Conform new renders; OpenToonz rendering and retiming.

Sound and accessible versions

Sound work includes dialogue recording and selection, cleanup and synchronization; ambience; Foley such as performed footsteps or clothing; designed effects; music; and the final mix. The tasks may belong to one person or several. Silence and room tone can be narrative choices, not merely missing sound.

Keep original recordings and take information. Identify temporary tracks, selected takes, edits and final versions. When useful, provide aligned dialogue, music and effects stems: grouped audio outputs, not necessarily every individual source track. Record their start, end and channel assumptions so the parts reconstruct the intended mix.

Listen to the combined mix, not only isolated tracks. Additive mixing can clip even when each source is individually below its limit. Check speech intelligibility, unwanted clicks, gaps, sync and intended dynamics. Loudness and channel requirements depend on the destination; this guide does not prescribe one numeric target for every film.

Plan access versions early. Captions include speech and meaningful sounds; translated subtitles are not automatically equivalent to full access captions. Audio description conveys important visual information, while a descriptive transcript can combine visual and audio information. Early planning helps reserve time for these elements rather than treating them as an afterthought.

Check caption language, timing, speaker identification, meaningful sound labels and readability. Avoid covering a clue or vital graphic. Embedded subtitle tracks and burned-in text are different deliverables, and support depends on the container and player. Preserve editable caption files alongside any burned-in copy.

Dependency warning. Krita stores the path to audio rather than embedding the audio content in its animation project. Renaming or moving that file can break the reference. A project that opens visually may still be missing its sound.

Sources: ScreenSkills animation sound designer; Audacity mixing; W3C planning accessible audio and video; Kdenlive rendering and subtitles; Krita audio for animation.

Rendering delivery and quality checks

Separate the editable project, intermediate renders, a finished master, a lightweight review copy and the target delivery version. They serve different purposes. A container such as MP4 or MKV is not itself a codec. Dimensions, frame rate, compression, color interpretation, transparency and audio configuration all affect what the receiver gets.

Image sequences can make selective repair practical: rerender only faulty source frames, then encode the repaired sequence into the movie. This avoids rerendering every animation frame, not necessarily re-encoding the video. Sequences still need an agreed naming convention, frame range and playback rate, and usually a separate sound handoff. Krita documents rendering frames before video encoding and warns that its video export does not preserve transparency; transparent regions can become black. Verify the actual receiving workflow rather than assuming an alpha channel survives every export.

Delivery checklist. Define the intended destination and requested versions. Reopen the actual exported file. Watch the entire film with sound, then inspect vulnerable cuts, effects and transitions frame by frame. Check duration and frame range, missing or duplicated frames, sync, dimensions, color, text legibility, captions, credits and required audio channels. Verify transparency if the handoff requires it. Check destination playback only where authorized.

Record which exact file and version was checked, what passed and what remains unresolved. "Export succeeded" is evidence of an export operation, not evidence that the film has passed visual, auditory or accessibility review. An output can be technically valid and still contain the wrong shot or an outdated line.

No actual film was rendered or subjected to these checks for this research. These are proposed acceptance questions to adapt to a real production, not completed test results or universal certification.

Sources: Krita render animation; Kdenlive rendering. The checklist is this report's synthesis.

Archive the work so it can be reopened

Preserve the final outputs and the editable production. An archive can include project files, source drawings or rigs, backgrounds, external media, permitted fonts and assets, original recordings, caption files, references, settings, application versions, review records and usage permissions. Keep enough context to distinguish intended choices from missing dependencies.

A filename containing "final" does not prove approval. Use an explicit version and a status appropriate to the deliverable. A lightweight status sequence might distinguish draft, review requested, changes needed, reviewed, ratification pending, ratified and delivered. This is a proposal for clarity, not a claim that all artistic decisions require a new formal ceremony. Keep deployment or release authority separate where it applies.

Test a copied archive rather than trusting the live working directory. Can the project open with its expected media? Can the receiver locate the selected cut and settings? Are unsupported dependencies identified? Kdenlive's archive function can gather project media and adjust paths, but choices such as excluding unused media should be deliberate.

Change example. Replacing one line of dialogue may affect lip-sync, drawing exposures, shot duration, sound edits, captions, translations and the relevance of earlier reviews. It does not necessarily invalidate every finished asset. Identify the affected dependencies and preserve unaffected work.

Archive handoff. State the selected production version, contained outputs, required software and dependencies, known omissions, rights status and the result of the reopening check. A successful open is useful evidence, but it does not by itself prove every effect, font or output reproduces identically.

Source: Kdenlive archiving. The broader preservation checklist and review status proposal are synthesis.

Free tools and where they fit

These are workflow options to investigate, not a benchmark, a verified installed stack or a promise of effortless interchange. Documentation references span versions; confirm the behavior of the release actually selected. A free application does not clear the rights to imported artwork, voices, music or fonts.

Krita. A raster drawing and hand-drawn animation option, with image-sequence output. Its application license is GPLv3. Its audio-link and video-transparency limitations described earlier matter when planning handoffs. Animation documentation; License.

OpenToonz. A route for traditional drawing levels, ink and paint, camera work, cutouts and compositing. The project describes free commercial and noncommercial use; main-source licensing and third-party components should be checked separately. Official project; Repository and licensing notes.

Blender Grease Pencil. An option for drawings in a 3D environment and hybrid scenes. Use it when the camera or mixed-media requirements justify that environment, not simply because it is available. Blender is GPL licensed. Versioned introduction (official indexed evidence); License.

Synfig. A free vector and bitmap animation option oriented toward tweened animation. The project provides a no-obligatory-payment download route and GPLv3 licensing. Official project; Stable download.

Kdenlive and Audacity. Kdenlive provides editing, captions and rendering; Audacity provides audio editing and mixing. Their current project references describe GPL licensing. Confirm the license of any chosen redistributed release rather than relying on an older manual's license summary. Kdenlive introduction; Audacity repository.

A modest candidate stack. Start by comparing Krita or OpenToonz for the visual work, Kdenlive for editorial and delivery, and Audacity for sound. Add Blender only if its hybrid environment solves an actual requirement. Before choosing, test one representative handoff for timing, color, alpha, sound and editable recovery. This recommendation is a research synthesis, not a completed interoperability test.

A worked nonfantasy scene

Illustrative project, not a completed film. A 20-second contemporary comedy in a railway waiting room: a commuter sees a sign reading "Quiet zone," silences a phone, then discovers the loud noise comes from a squeaky suitcase wheel. The example uses a chosen 24 fps timebase solely for planning.

Story objective. Establish the commuter's concern about disturbing others, then redirect the cause of the noise. Preserve the difference between what the character believes and what the audience knows.

Shot A, 0 to 5 seconds. A wide view establishes the sign, commuter and suitcase. The sound begins as the suitcase moves. Boards decide whether the wheel is visible; the animatic tests whether the setting and sign can be read without overexplaining.

Shot B, 5 to 11 seconds. A medium view shows a pause, glance at the phone and deliberate silencing gesture. A held body with changing eyes and hand may be enough. The pause is an acting choice, not a blank to fill with more movement.

Shot C, 11 to 16 seconds. The commuter moves again; the squeak returns. Layout must maintain the suitcase's location and ground contact. The sound timing should follow the wheel action, not an unrelated stock loop.

Shot D, 16 to 20 seconds. A closer view reveals the wheel. The commuter looks toward it, then stops. The ending depends on the audience having time to connect the cause and effect. The shot durations are hypotheses to revise in the animatic, not tested audience findings.

Asset plan. Commuter design, suitcase with wheel variants, phone, sign, waiting-room background, foreground seating if needed, squeak recording and room tone. A cutout body with drawn hand substitutions could be sufficient; a hand-drawn performance is also valid. No method is selected merely because the subject is comedy.

Checks by stage. Script: causal order clear. Boards: sign and wheel visibility intentional. Animatic: reading and reaction time plausible. Layout: consistent ground and prop positions.

Animation: contact and hesitation readable. Sound: squeak linked to the action. Finish: text remains legible in the actual delivery size. Archive: retain editable timing and the permitted sound source.

Other genres. Mystery can withhold a key object's visibility; drama can concentrate on a difficult pause; documentary can simplify motion to explain a mechanism; science fiction can use unfamiliar design while still requiring consistent spatial cues. Genre changes the communication goal, not the need to distinguish plan, timing, performance and finished output.

Proposed Blackwish applications

Blackwish could assist with describing production decisions before they become costly visual work. The immediate opportunity is not to claim automatic filmmaking, but to improve the text that artists, editors and reviewers use.

Typed production descriptions. Distinguish script event, board proposal, timed animatic hypothesis, layout requirement, animation note and final-output observation. This reduces the chance that a statement verified at one stage is treated as proof at another.

Continuity and alternatives. Track character knowledge, prop state, screen visibility, chronology and deliberate ambiguity. Offer alternate staging that preserves the intended event instead of silently resolving an ambiguous sentence into one performance.

Timing and dependencies. Record timebase, duration, drawing exposure and audio timing as separate concepts. Identify which downstream items depend on a changed cut, asset or temporary recording. A text ledger can describe these relations without claiming that the visual project has been inspected.

Evidence and handoffs. Keep source, version, temporary/final status, review outcome and unresolved questions with the proposed handoff. Distinguish a source claim, an artistic hypothesis, a rendered observation and a user ratification.

Boundary. These are proposed text-engine applications. No film assets were produced or motion-tested for this dossier. It does not establish audience response, tool interoperability, rights clearance or operational deployment. A future implementation would need its own authorized scope and appropriate tests.

A useful next research step. Prepare one text-only production packet for a short nonfantasy scene: brief, shot list, timing assumptions, asset needs, continuity questions, sound/access notes and review checklist. Compare alternate animation methods on that same scene. This would test specification clarity without pretending to complete the film.

Review record and adoption boundary

The following operational labels organize a bounded review: POINT is the claim or objective; BRIDGE is supporting evidence and authority; PATH is consequences, alternatives and termination; SHADOW is hidden assumptions, counterexamples and failure risk. They are used here as review labels, not as a claim to reproduce an unavailable full canonical definition.

Zen review one on representation. POINT: production stages should be distinguishable. BRIDGE: official workflows distinguish boards, timed edits, layouts and animation. PATH: keep each artifact's purpose and version explicit; stop a stage claim at the evidence actually available. SHADOW: a polished script can still have impossible staging, and a persuasive animatic can still fail in final performance. Proposed disposition: preserve typed stages without forcing every project into identical departments.

Zen review two on dependencies. POINT: timing and asset changes need visible downstream consequences. BRIDGE: exposure sheets, camera hierarchies, linked media and export behavior demonstrate different dependency types. PATH: describe cut, asset and media baselines; reopen affected checks after a consequential change. SHADOW: shared palettes, missing audio links or still-only exports can defeat a superficially complete handoff. Proposed disposition: use proportional dependency records, not mandatory bureaucracy for every tiny sketch.

Zen review three on scope and evidence. POINT: research can inform Blackwish without silently expanding it. BRIDGE: the established boundary is text-first assistance with preserved sources and manual ratification for adoption or deployment. PATH: prepare proposed specifications and alternatives; seek applicable authority before implementing a visual engine or conducting external production activities. SHADOW: calling a proposal a capability, or calling a review a ratification, would overstate the result. Proposed disposition: retain conditional language and separate factual evidence from adoption decisions.

Death Knell challenge. Would this framework reject an effective held drawing, nonlinear workflow, experimental style or deliberately ambiguous scene? If so, narrow the control rather than reject the art. Would it declare a film complete merely because a file exported? If so, require purpose-specific output and archive checks. Would it imply full historical or canonical compatibility from a limited review? If so, remove that claim.

Bounded outcome. The proposed controls can be considered for adoption while preserving artistic flexibility, source uncertainty and the text-engine boundary. This is not scientific certification, exhaustive historical verification, manual ratification or deployment. Compatibility review is limited to the available established constraints: text-first scope, preservation of originals and evidence, and separation of research, review, ratification and deployment.